

Programming Fundamentals 1

An Introduction to the module

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Agenda

- *Lecturers / Tutors*
- *Module Structure & Delivery*
- *Technologies*
- *Module Assessment (Assignments)*
- *Troubleshooting*
- *Ethos*

Introducing your lecturers / tutors

Siobhan Roche

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Mairead Meagher

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Programming Technologies

Assignments



100% Continuous Assessment (CA).



All Individual assignments (no team-based ones).



Submit via Moodle assignment dropboxes.



Hard deadlines;
extensions only permitted if [mitigating circumstances](#)
apply.



Interviews

What to do if you don't know what to do...

Ask in Class or at labs: Just put your hand up or wait until the end of the class, its up to you but asking during the class really helps all the students



Message your lecturer in Slack: You can always send us a private message and we will respond before the end of the next college day.



Post the issue in Slack;
think of it as asking a question in a classroom.
Include any screen shots, screen recordings, etc.
you think might help with solving the problem.

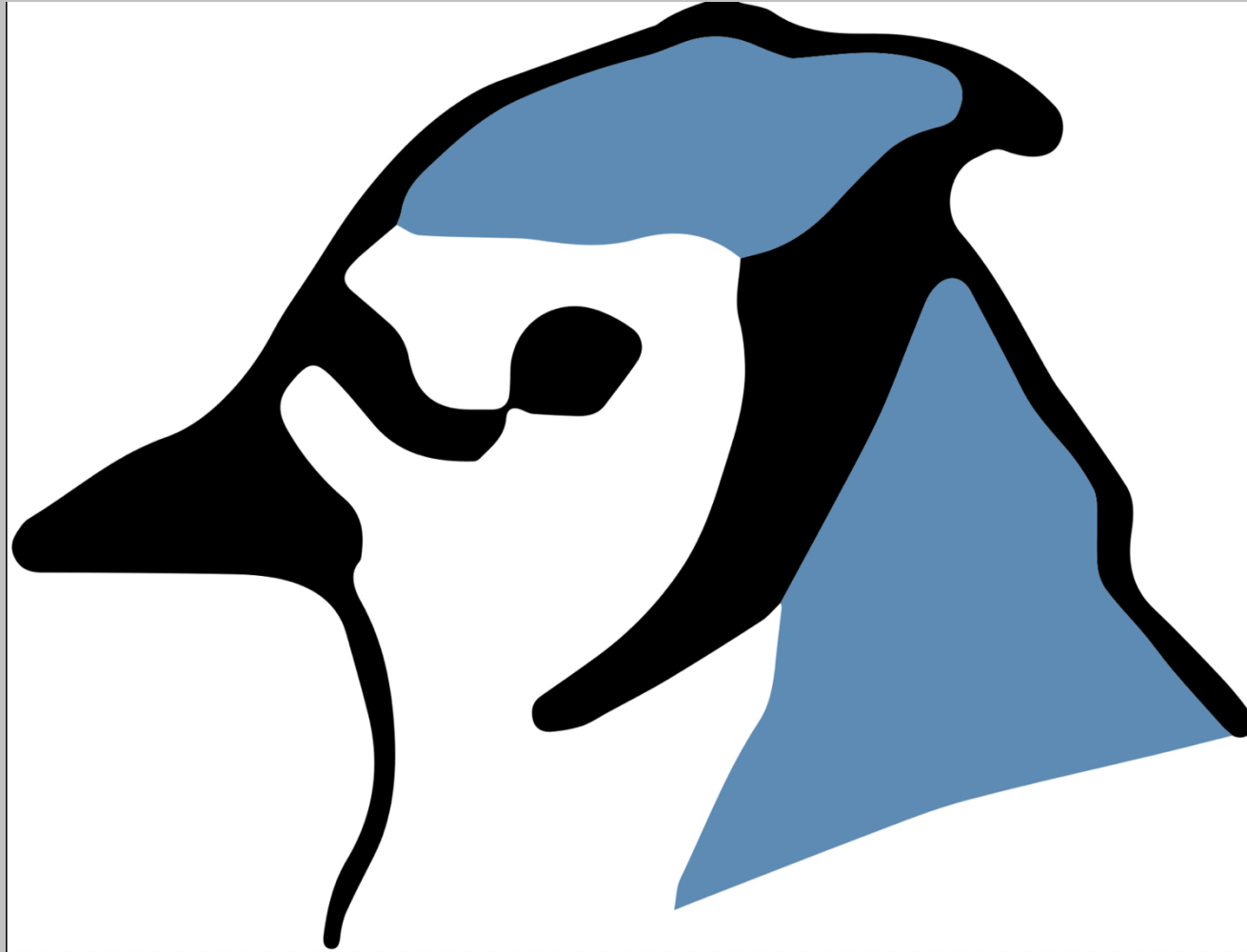


We encourage classmates to help each other (**peer learning**), if you know the answer to another student's issue, please do respond.

Ethos

- **Self-directed learning** outside of lectures / labs.
- Inquisitive and motivated.
- Help your **peers (use #Slack!)**.
- **Engagement** and staying current with the module.
- All work submitted must be **your own work**.
 - all code/approaches given in the module by us can be re-used / re-purposed in your assignments.

Introduction to BlueJ



What is BlueJ?



BlueJ is a simple program you'll use to learn Java. It's designed for beginners, so it avoids the clutter of professional coding tools and lets you focus on the basics.

- You'll see your program as boxes (classes) that you can click on.
- You can create objects and test what they can do without writing extra code.
- The editor helps you write neatly and spot mistakes more easily.
- It's free and works on most computers.

Think of BlueJ as training wheels for Java: it helps you experiment, see results quickly, and understand the core ideas of programming.



What language is behind Bluej



BlueJ doesn't come with its own Java — it depends on the Java Development Kit (JDK) you install.

The **current release (BlueJ 5.7.0, May 2024)** works with:

- *Java 11 (LTS)*
- **Java 17 (LTS)**
- **Java 21 (LTS, current recommended version)**

Why are we using BlueJ?

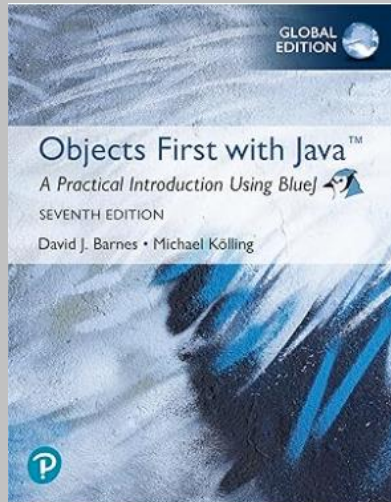


- It's developed for introductory programming courses
- Objects first approach
- Minimal interface and reduced distraction versus full Integrated Development Environments
- Immediate Feedback

References



- This course is largely based on the Book



Objects First with Java: A Practical Introduction
Using BlueJ,
Global Edition Paperback – 21 July 2025
by David Barnes (Author), Michael Kölling (Author)

Questions?

